

# Skills Summary

## Counting Detective: Missing and Misplaced Numbers

*Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.*

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### Skill 1 — Filling a Missing Number

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**Rule:** Use the neighbors! Read the number just **before** the empty box and count on one more. Then check: your answer must come right before the next number on the track.

**Example:** A track shows 25, 26, \_\_, 28. What goes in the empty box?

**Step 1.** Read the neighbor before the box (26) and count on one — then check against the neighbor after.

**Step 2.** One more than 26 is **27**, and 27 comes right before 28. It fits both neighbors.

**Try it:** A track shows 61, 62, \_\_, 64. What goes in the empty box?

check: 63

**(!) Watch out:** Don't copy the neighbor! The empty box holds a *new* number — one more than the number before it.

### Skill 2 — Spotting a Counting Mistake

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**Rule:** Whisper-count from the start of the row while pointing at each number. The first number that does **not** match your whisper-count is the mistake.

**Example:** The count “9, 10, 12” skips a number. What is missing?

**Step 1.** Whisper-count and match: “9, 10, ...” — the count says a number belongs between 10 and 12.

**Step 2.** One more than 10 is **11**, so the count should read 9, 10, 11, 12.

**Try it:** The count “28, 29, 31” skips a number. What is missing?

check: 30

### Skill 3 — Putting Numbers Back in Order

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**Rule:** Counting order is least to greatest: the number you would say **first** when counting is the **least**.

**Example:** Put the cards 14, 12, 13 in counting order.

**Step 1.** Whisper-count and grab each card as its number is said — the card said first is least.

**Step 2.** Counting “12, 13, 14” collects them in order: **12, 13, 14**.

**Try it:** Put the cards 8, 6, 7 in counting order.

check: 6, 7, 8